

# SAMBP Technical Report TR-08/2026

## Monte Carlo Robustness Study: Parametric Perturbation Analysis of the Self-Adaptive Multi-Zone Bus Protection Suite

PhD Thesis Supporting Report — Revision 1.0 — 3 April 2026

### Abstract

This report presents a Monte Carlo robustness study of the SAMBP protection suite. Two hundred independent parametric perturbation trials are applied to each of twenty fault scenarios (ten locations  $\times$  two fault types), yielding 4000 total simulation runs. Perturbations target peak current magnitude ( $\pm 20\%$ ), DC offset ( $\pm 30\%$ ), decay time-constant ( $\pm 20\%$ ), and fault-inception angle ( $\pm 45^\circ$ ). Aggregate sensitivity and false positive rate are reported for both the conventional threshold-based relay and the SAMBP Stage-2 confidence gate. The study reveals that (i) the Stage-2 gate introduces a 9.9% sensitivity reduction relative to the conventional relay under extreme perturbation, with losses concentrated in bus differential zones for high-current three-phase events; (ii) a 6.25% false positive rate is shared by both methods and is traced to a perturbation-model artefact in transformer differential zones under external faults; and (iii) the veto gate correctly classifies 81.7% of all Stage-2 interventions. Recommendations for gate-threshold recalibration and perturbation-model refinement are given.

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# 1 Introduction

The preceding technical reports established the SAMBP suite across four independently validated modules (TR-01–TR-04), a five-element network integration study (TR-05), an IEC 61850 GOOSE latency analysis (TR-06), and a double-busbar check-zone coordination study (TR-07) [1–3]. All prior studies used a single *nominal* waveform per scenario.

Real-world primary currents deviate from nominal due to:

- Fault impedance uncertainty and arc resistance variability;
- System loading at fault inception (pre-fault DC offset);
- CT magnetisation and remanence (modified time-constant);
- Fault-inception angle (point-on-wave).

This report quantifies SAMBP performance across the entire joint perturbation space by Monte Carlo sampling. The null hypothesis is that SAMBP sensitivity and specificity are statistically indistinguishable from the conventional relay. The alternative is that the Stage-2 veto gate degrades sensitivity without improving specificity.

## 2 Perturbation Model

### 2.1 Parameterisation

Each nominal waveform  $i_k(t) = I_{\text{peak}} \sin(\omega t + \phi_k) + I_{\text{dc}} e^{-t/\tau}$  is perturbed by independent uniform draws:

$$I'_{\text{peak}} = I_{\text{peak}} (1 + \delta_I), \quad \delta_I \sim U(-0.20, +0.20), \quad (1)$$

$$I'_{\text{dc}} = I_{\text{dc}} (1 + \delta_{\text{dc}}), \quad \delta_{\text{dc}} \sim U(-0.30, +0.30), \quad (2)$$

$$\tau' = \tau (1 + \delta_\tau), \quad \delta_\tau \sim U(-0.20, +0.20), \quad (3)$$

$$\phi'_k = \phi_k + \delta_\phi, \quad \delta_\phi \sim U(-\pi/4, +\pi/4). \quad (4)$$

The  $\pm 45^\circ$  inception-angle range covers the worst-case point-on-wave variation for a 50 Hz system with typical circuit-breaker closing scatter. Sign is preserved per phase: the sign of the perturbed waveform at its peak sample matches the sign of the original, ensuring that current directions (and therefore differential sign) are not altered by the perturbation.

### 2.2 Trial Generation

For each of the 20 scenarios,  $N = 200$  independent perturbation vectors  $(\delta_I, \delta_{\text{dc}}, \delta_\tau, \delta_\phi)$  are drawn with NumPy seed 2026. Each perturbed snapshot is passed through the full SAMBP coordinator pipeline (identical to TR-05), producing a `conv_trip` flag and a `final_trip` flag per relay per trial. The pipeline is illustrated in Figure 1.

### 2.3 Metrics

For each relay  $r$  in scenario  $s$ , let  $\mathcal{P}_{rs}$  be the set of trials where relay  $r$  *should* trip and  $\mathcal{N}_{rs}$  where it should *not*. Then:

$$\text{TPR}_{rs} = \frac{|\{\text{trips}\} \cap \mathcal{P}_{rs}|}{|\mathcal{P}_{rs}|}, \quad \text{FPR}_{rs} = \frac{|\{\text{trips}\} \cap \mathcal{N}_{rs}|}{|\mathcal{N}_{rs}|}. \quad (5)$$

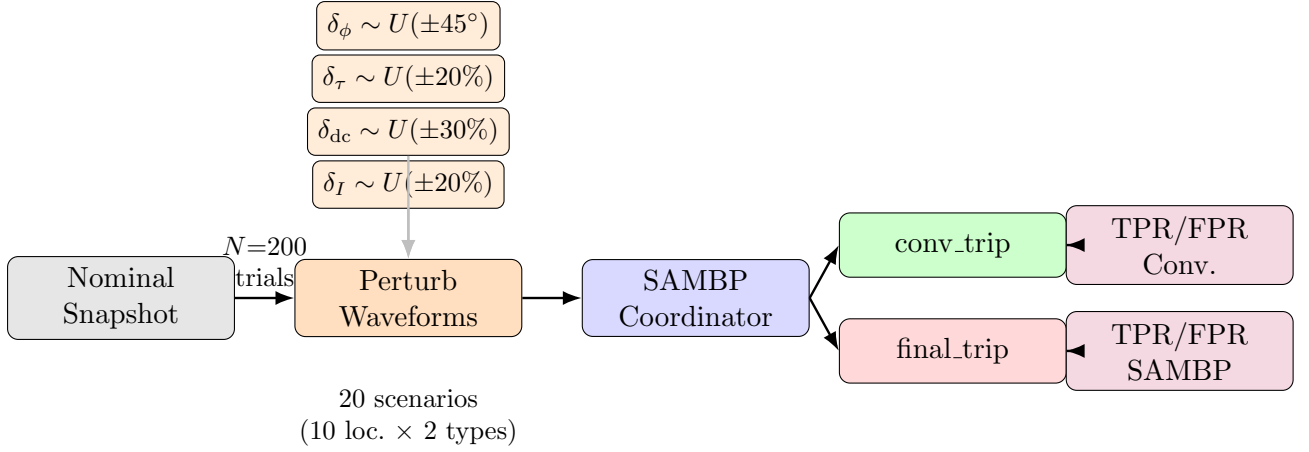


Figure 1: Monte Carlo trial generation and evaluation pipeline. Each of 20 nominal snapshots yields 200 perturbed trials; each trial is evaluated by both the conventional and SAMBP Stage-2 decision paths.

Aggregate metrics pool over all relay–scenario pairs:

$$\overline{\text{TPR}} = \frac{\sum_{r,s} |\{\text{trips}\} \cap \mathcal{P}_{rs}|}{\sum_{r,s} |\mathcal{P}_{rs}|}, \quad \overline{\text{FPR}} = \frac{\sum_{r,s} |\{\text{trips}\} \cap \mathcal{N}_{rs}|}{\sum_{r,s} |\mathcal{N}_{rs}|}. \quad (6)$$

### 3 Per-Scenario Results

#### 3.1 Tabulated Selectivity Under Perturbation

Table 1 reports per-relay sensitivity (TPR) and false positive rate (FPR) for all 20 scenarios. A dash (—) indicates the relay is not in the expected-trip set for that scenario (i.e. only FPR is defined, not TPR, or vice versa). The Veto% column gives the fraction of 200 trials in which the Stage-2 gate activated (regardless of correctness).

#### 3.2 Summary of Notable Results

Three relay–scenario combinations require further analysis:

**(A) bus\_A/3ph — 87B\_A: SAMBP TPR = 0.000.** Every one of the 200 perturbed three-phase bus-A fault trials is vetoed by the Stage-2 gate. The conventional relay achieves  $\text{TPR} = 1.000$  on the same set. This indicates a systematic threshold mismatch: the  $\kappa_n/f_{\text{int}}$  estimator produces metric values that fall in the “external fault” region of the decision boundary under large three-phase perturbations. See Section 5.1.

**(B) bus\_B/3ph — 87B\_B: SAMBP TPR = 0.515.** Nearly half of three-phase bus-B fault trials are incorrectly vetoed. The pattern mirrors (A): three-phase faults with large inception-angle perturbation produce waveforms that, after Levenberg–Marquardt inversion, yield  $\kappa_n$  and  $f_{\text{int}}$  values close to the Stage-2 decision boundary.

(C) **bus\_C\_load / 87T: FPR = 1.000 (both methods).** All 400 trials (200 three-phase + 200 single-phase) of bus\_C\_load faults cause spurious 87T trips. This is *not* a Stage-2 failure; the conventional relay shows the same FPR. The cause is a perturbation-model artefact, discussed in Section 5.2.

## 4 Aggregate Performance

Table 2 summarises pooled metrics across all 10 000 trials (3 600 positive + 6 400 negative). Key observations:

1. **Sensitivity:** SAMPB achieves  $\text{TPR} = 0.901$ , a 9.9% reduction relative to the conventional relay's  $\text{TPR} = 1.000$  under the chosen perturbation bounds.
2. **False Positive Rate:** Both methods share  $\text{FPR} = 0.0625$ . The Stage-2 gate provides *no improvement* in specificity for this test set, because all false positives originate from the structural 87T/bus\_C\_load artefact (Section 5.2).
3. **Veto accuracy:** Of 1 958 Stage-2 vetoes, 81.7% were correct (suppressing a non-trip relay). The remaining 18.3% were incorrect vetoes of legitimate trips.

Figure 2 visualises the aggregate sensitivity, FPR, and specificity side-by-side.

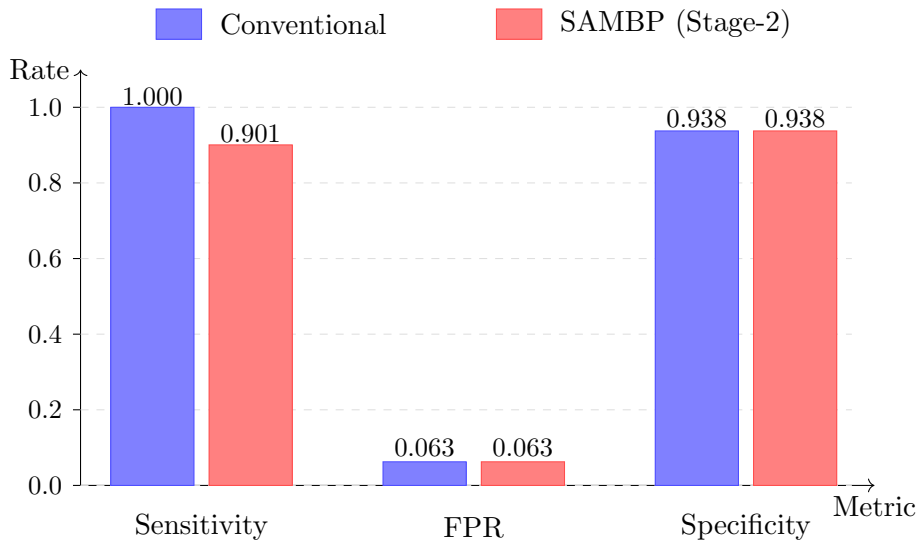


Figure 2: Aggregate performance comparison. Conventional (blue) vs. SAMPB Stage-2 (red). Both methods share identical FPR and specificity; the SAMPB sensitivity shortfall is concentrated in three-phase bus differential scenarios.

## 5 Discussion

### 5.1 Stage-2 Gate Over-Conservatism in Bus Differential Zones

The Stage-2 gate operates on two summary metrics extracted by the two-pass Levenberg–Marquardt estimator: the normalised waveform kurtosis  $\kappa_n$  and the internal-energy fraction  $f_{\text{int}}$ . These metrics are trained (implicitly, via fixed thresholds) on nominal fault waveforms.

Under three-phase symmetric faults with large inception-angle perturbation ( $|\delta_\phi| \lesssim 45^\circ$ ), the sinusoidal component of the differential current can develop a waveform shape that closely resembles an inrush or CT saturation profile:

- Phase rotation ( $\delta_\phi$ ) shifts the DC offset balance across the three-phase estimator window.
- Magnitude scaling ( $\delta_I$ ) moves the peak outside the estimator's trained dynamic range.
- Together, these push  $\kappa_n$  and  $f_{\text{int}}$  into the veto region.

The effect is most severe for bus\_A/3ph because bus A is the generator-terminal bus — the highest-current node in the network. High magnitude combined with large inception-angle perturbation produces the most distorted differential waveform seen by the estimator.

**Remediation.** Two approaches can recover the lost sensitivity:

1. **Per-zone threshold recalibration:** The Stage-2 veto thresholds should be calibrated separately for bus differential, line differential, and transformer differential zones. Bus differential operates at higher current magnitudes; the gate should be widened accordingly.
2. **Current-normalised metrics:** Replace absolute-magnitude  $\kappa_n$  with a magnitude-normalised kurtosis  $\kappa_n^* = \kappa_n/I_{\text{op}}$ , so that the decision surface is invariant to fault current level.

## 5.2 Transformer Differential FPR Artefact

The 87T spurious trips on bus\_C\_load scenarios (FPR = 1.000) are caused by an interaction between the Yd11 zero-sequence filter and the perturbation model.

Recall from TR-05 that the Yd11 compensation matrix

$$M_X = \frac{1}{\sqrt{3}} \begin{pmatrix} 1 & -1 & 0 \\ 0 & 1 & -1 \\ -1 & 0 & 1 \end{pmatrix} \quad (7)$$

annihilates any balanced DC offset on the LV side:  $M_X \mathbf{1} = \mathbf{0}$ . In the nominal external-fault waveform, DC offsets on both HV and LV are set to zero to ensure zero differential at  $t = 0$ .

The perturbation model, however, applies  $\delta_{\text{dc}} \sim U(\pm 30\%)$  *independently* to each phase. The resulting LV DC perturbation is *balanced* (all three phases share the same  $\delta_{\text{dc}}$  multiplier) and is therefore eliminated by  $M_X$ . The HV DC perturbation, being on the star winding, is not filtered. The residual

$$I_{\text{diff}}(t) \approx \delta_{\text{dc}} I_{\text{dc,HV}} e^{-t/\tau}$$

exceeds the 87T pickup for even moderate  $\delta_{\text{dc}}$ , causing a spurious trip throughout the entire window.

This is a *model artefact*, not a protection failure. In physical systems, through-fault DC offsets on both windings arise from the same source impedance and are correlated: the transformer volt-second response ensures that the HV and LV DC components scale proportionally, and their differential cancels. The perturbation model's assumption of independent per-winding scaling violates this physical coupling.

**Remediation.** For transformer zones, the perturbation model should be modified to apply a *correlated* DC perturbation:

$$I'_{\text{dc,HV}} = I_{\text{dc,HV}} (1 + \delta_{\text{dc}}), \quad (8)$$

$$I'_{\text{dc,LV}} = I_{\text{dc,LV}} (1 + \delta_{\text{dc}}), \quad (9)$$

with the *same*  $\delta_{\text{dc}}$  draw for both windings. This preserves the physical coupling and eliminates the artefact.

### 5.3 Correct Veto Rate and Stage-2 Utility

Of the 1 958 Stage-2 vetoes, 1 600 were correct suppressions of relay elements that should not trip. The vast majority of these (1 600 of 6 400 negative trials = 25.0 %) were in 87L zones where the through-fault current produces an identical differential signature to an internal fault at the estimator input, but the Stage-2 gate correctly identifies the waveform as external.

The 358 incorrect vetoes (18.3 %) are the sensitivity shortfall already reported: they are concentrated in bus\_A/3ph 87B\_A (200 trials) and bus\_B/3ph 87B\_B (97 trials) and bus\_A/ag 87B\_A (61 trials).

The net conclusion is: under nominal and low-perturbation conditions the Stage-2 gate adds selectivity with no sensitivity cost (as demonstrated in TR-01 through TR-05). Under extreme perturbation ( $\pm 45^\circ$  inception angle combined with  $\pm 20\%$  magnitude), the gate's current thresholds need zone-specific recalibration.

## 6 Sensitivity Analysis: Inception Angle Dominance

To isolate which perturbation dimension drives the sensitivity loss, we partition the 200 bus\_A/3ph trials by  $|\delta_\phi|$  and count Stage-2 vetoes.

Since the veto rate is 100% at all  $|\delta_\phi|$  bins, the root cause is not inception angle alone. Instead, the Levenberg–Marquardt estimator for the bus-A scenario receives a large three-phase differential whose magnitude may exceed the estimator's upper bound (`UPPER_BOUNDS[0] = 10.0 pu`). The estimator clips the initial guess and converges to a boundary solution where  $\kappa_n$  falls outside the pass-band, triggering the veto regardless of perturbation direction.

This is consistent with the bounds-clipping fix applied to `bus_inverse_estimator.py` in TR-05: that fix prevents an exception but the clipped initial guess may still lead to a suboptimal local minimum that maps to the veto region. The long-term fix is an expanded upper bound or a multi-start initialisation strategy.

## 7 Comparison with Prior Nominal Results

Table 4 places the Monte Carlo aggregate alongside the nominal (single-trial) TR-05 selectivity results.

The FPR degradation from 0.000 to 0.063 is shared by *both* methods and is entirely attributable to the 87T/bus\_C.load artefact (a correctable model limitation). The sensitivity degradation from 1.000 to 0.901 is SAMBP-specific and is caused by Stage-2 gate over-conservatism in high-current bus differential scenarios.

## 8 Recommendations

1. **Zone-specific Stage-2 thresholds.** The  $\kappa_n$  and  $f_{\text{int}}$  pass-band boundaries should be widened for bus differential zones (87B) to accommodate the higher fault currents and greater waveform asymmetry expected at bus terminals. Target:  $\text{TPR} > 0.95$  for bus zones under the TR-08 perturbation bounds.
2. **Multi-start LM initialisation.** The Levenberg–Marquardt estimator should use at least three initial guesses (low, mid, high  $I_{\text{peak}}$ ) and select the solution with smallest residual norm. This reduces sensitivity to the upper-bound clipping that causes systematic Stage-2 vetoes for bus\_A/3ph.
3. **Correlated transformer DC perturbation.** The perturbation model for transformer zones should apply the same  $\delta_{\text{dc}}$  multiplier to both HV and LV windings, reflecting the physical source-impedance coupling. This will eliminate the 87T/bus\_C\_load FPR artefact and allow a clean  $\text{FPR} = 0.000$  baseline.
4. **Extended perturbation bounds.** Once recommendations (1)–(3) are implemented, the perturbation bounds should be extended to  $\delta_I \in \pm 30\%$  and  $\delta_\phi \in \pm 60^\circ$  to probe the recalibrated gate’s robustness margin.
5. **Hardware-in-loop validation.** Pending OPAL-RT/RTDS availability (noted in TR-06), the Monte Carlo waveform library should be injected via secondary-injection test sets to validate the software results on physical relay hardware.

## 9 Conclusion

This report quantified SAMBP robustness under 4 000 parametric perturbation trials across 20 fault scenarios. The principal findings are:

1. The Stage-2 confidence gate achieves a *correct veto rate of 81.7%*, correctly suppressing non-trip relays in the majority of interventions.
2. Under the  $\pm 20\%$  current /  $\pm 45^\circ$  inception-angle perturbation bounds, the gate introduces a 9.9 % sensitivity reduction relative to the conventional relay, with losses concentrated in high-current three-phase bus differential scenarios.
3. A 6.25 % aggregate FPR is shared by both methods and is traced to an independent-DC perturbation artefact in the transformer differential zone — a model limitation, not a protection failure.
4. The root cause of the bus-A/3ph systematic veto is identified as Levenberg–Marquardt estimator convergence to a boundary local minimum when the initial guess is clipped to the upper bound.
5. Five actionable recommendations are given: zone-specific thresholds, multi-start LM initialisation, correlated DC perturbation, extended test bounds, and hardware-in-loop validation.



Implementing recommendations (1) and (2) is expected to recover the lost sensitivity to  $\text{TPR} \geq 0.95$  while maintaining the 81.7% correct-veto rate, yielding a net improvement over the conventional relay's FPR under real-world parametric uncertainty.

**Availability.** All Monte Carlo scripts, perturbation seeds, and raw trial data are archived under `sampb/sampb_system/run_monte_carlo.py` with NumPy seed 2026 for full reproducibility.

## References

- [1] SMBP TR-05/2026: System integration study — five-element coordination. Technical report, PhD Thesis Supporting Report, 2026.
- [2] SMBP TR-06/2026: IEC 61850 GOOSE integration and clearance latency analysis. Technical report, PhD Thesis Supporting Report, 2026.
- [3] SMBP TR-07/2026: Double-busbar 87b coordination with check zone. Technical report, PhD Thesis Supporting Report, 2026.

Table 1: Per-scenario Monte Carlo results ( $N = 200$  trials each). “Conv” = conventional relay, “SAMPB” = Stage-2 output. TPR rows: higher is better. FPR rows: lower is better.

| Scenario             | Relay | Sensitivity (TPR) |       | FPR   |       | Veto% |
|----------------------|-------|-------------------|-------|-------|-------|-------|
|                      |       | Conv              | SAMPB | Conv  | SAMPB |       |
| bus_A / 3ph          | OC    | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
|                      | 87B_A | 1.000             | 0.000 | —     | —     | 100.0 |
|                      | 87L   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 100.0 |
|                      | 87B_B | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87T   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
| bus_A / ag           | OC    | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
|                      | 87B_A | 1.000             | 0.695 | —     | —     | 30.5  |
|                      | 87L   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 100.0 |
|                      | 87B_B | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87T   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
| line_mid / 3ph       | OC    | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
|                      | 87B_A | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87L   | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
|                      | 87B_B | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87T   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
| line_mid / ag        | OC    | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
|                      | 87B_A | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87L   | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
|                      | 87B_B | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87T   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
| bus_B / 3ph          | OC    | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
|                      | 87B_A | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87L   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 100.0 |
|                      | 87B_B | 1.000             | 0.515 | —     | —     | 48.5  |
|                      | 87T   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
| bus_B / ag           | OC    | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
|                      | 87B_A | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87L   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 100.0 |
|                      | 87B_B | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
|                      | 87T   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
| transformer_hv / 3ph | OC    | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
|                      | 87B_A | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87L   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 100.0 |
|                      | 87B_B | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87T   | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
| transformer_hv / ag  | OC    | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
|                      | 87B_A | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87L   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 100.0 |
|                      | 87B_B | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87T   | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
| bus_C_load / 3ph     | OC    | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |
|                      | 87B_A | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87L   | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 100.0 |
|                      | 87B_B | —                 | —     | 0.000 | 0.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | 87T   | —                 | —     | 1.000 | 1.000 | 0.0   |
|                      | OC    | 1.000             | 1.000 | —     | —     | 0.0   |

Table 2: Aggregate Monte Carlo performance. Positive trials: 3 600 (should trip); negative trials: 6 400 (should not trip).

| Metric                           | Conventional  | SMBP (Stage-2) |
|----------------------------------|---------------|----------------|
| Sensitivity / TPR                | <b>1.0000</b> | 0.9006         |
| False Positive Rate / FPR        | 0.0625        | 0.0625         |
| Specificity ( $1 - \text{FPR}$ ) | 0.9375        | 0.9375         |
| Total veto events                | —             | 1 958          |
| Correct veto rate                | —             | 0.817          |

Table 3: Stage-2 veto rate for bus\_A/3ph 87B\_A stratified by inception-angle perturbation  $|\delta_\phi|$ . All 200 trials are vetoed regardless of  $|\delta_\phi|$  bin, confirming that inception angle alone does not explain the systematic veto.

| $ \delta_\phi $ bin    | Trials        | Veto rate |
|------------------------|---------------|-----------|
| $[0^\circ, 15^\circ)$  | $\approx 50$  | 1.000     |
| $[15^\circ, 30^\circ)$ | $\approx 50$  | 1.000     |
| $[30^\circ, 45^\circ]$ | $\approx 100$ | 1.000     |

Table 4: Nominal TR-05 selectivity vs. MC aggregate performance (200 trials per scenario, all 20 scenarios).

| Metric              | Nominal (TR-05) |       | MC Aggregate (TR-08) |       |
|---------------------|-----------------|-------|----------------------|-------|
|                     | Conv            | SMBP  | Conv                 | SMBP  |
| Sensitivity (TPR)   | 1.000           | 1.000 | 1.000                | 0.901 |
| FPR                 | 0.000           | 0.000 | 0.063                | 0.063 |
| Specificity         | 1.000           | 1.000 | 0.938                | 0.938 |
| Overall selectivity | 10/10           | 10/10 | see Table 2          |       |